

t PIN instead.

If another user is CCed on the ticket, once you've verified the PIN ask them to generate a new PIN to revoke the previous one.

## Account Ownership Changes

This section has been moved to the Account Changes workflow.

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/admin\_note.md

## Overview

The admin note serves as a quick reference for any account changes or action performed on a GitLab.com namespace. For example, it also helps to determine if the user was previously flagged for any violations to prevent any further abuse.

If you encounter a situation with the following cases, an admin note is required.

- User requested change
- Compute minutes reset
- Legal case
- Security or Abuse case

## Adding the Note

Adding an admin note can be done using one of the following methods:

### 1. Admin account

1. Navigate to the admin page for the user (/admin/users/username) or top-level group (admin/groups/namespacepath)

1. Click Edit

1. Add the relevant admin note

1. Click Save when done

1. ChatOps (only available for users):

1. Find the user to confirm it's the proper account: /chatops run user find <username or current email>

1. Add the admin note: /chatops run user note <username or current email> 'admin note here'

In general, the formatting should be standard in a one liner format:

- Violation: Date | Note | Case | Link
- Action Taken: Date | Note | Link

Slack conversations or issue links may be used for the link if no ticket is lodged for the type of request.

## Viewing the Notes

There are two methods a team member can use to look up admin notes for a particular user:

1. If the team member has admin privileges, they can navigate to the admin page for the relevant namespace where the admin note will be present.

1. (Users only) Team members can use ChatOps to read admin notes for a particular user via the following command in a Slack channel where the chatops bot has been invited

> /chatops run user find <username or email>

### Sample Notes

Disabling 2FA:

2025-01-16 | 2FA removed | user requested | <https://gitlab.zendesk.com/agent/tickets/123>

Email Address Change/Removal:

2025-01-16 | Primary Email Change - No Access | User Requested |  
<https://gitlab.zendesk.com/agent/tickets/123>

DMCA Request:

2025-01-16 | DMCA Violation | Abuse | <https://gitlab.zendesk.com/agent/tickets/123>

Abuse Case:

2025-01-16 | Flagged for terms violation | Abuse Case |  
<https://gitlab.zendesk.com/agent/tickets/123>

User Blocked:

2025-01-16 | User blocked by infra | <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/support/internal-requests/issues/441>

Name Squatting Rename:

2025-01-16 | Name Squatting Request | <https://gitlab.zendesk.com/agent/tickets/123>

Compute minutes reset:

2025-01-16 | Compute minutes reset | Bug | <https://gitlab.zendesk.com/agent/tickets/123>

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/advanced-sast-code-request.md

For requests concerning the source code of LGPL-licensed components in GitLab Advanced SAST, use the Advanced SAST App in Zendesk. The app automates the process and guides you until a legal issue is created.

Once a legal issue is created, Dev Pulse is activated on the ticket (treating it as a RFH). The ticket will remain on-hold until the legal issue is updated, at which point you will be instructed what to say/do by our legal team.

If the issue requires additional communication, use the General::Waiting on RFH macro to re-activate Dev Pulse.

If you encounter any issues or have any questions as you work on the ticket, please Cc Jason

Colyer on the ticket and add an internal note about the issue/question.

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/ai\_features.md

## Overview

This workflow covers all tickets related to AI features released to our customer base.

## Workflow

During this phase of the process, the scope of Support will be to gather all relevant feedback regarding bugs and feature enhancements.

After gathering the necessary information, such as errors, outcomes and expected outcomes, support should add this information to the feedback issue specific to the AI feature.

## AI Features table

This table links to the epic name or production documentation, along with the relevant feedback issue to use.

|                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AI Feature   Feedback issue                                                         |
| -----   -----                                                                       |
| AI for Developer Teams: Suggested Reviewers   Issue                                 |
| AI for Developer Teams: Code suggestions   Issue                                    |
| AI for Developer Teams: Summarize my MR review   Issue                              |
| AI for Developer Teams: Summarize proposed MR Changes   Issue                       |
| AI for Security and Operations: Explain this vulnerability   Issue                  |
| AI for Security and Operations: Explain this block of code in repository UI   Issue |
| AI for Security and Operations: Generate tests in MR   Issue                        |
| AI for Everyone: Summarize Issue Comments   Issue                                   |
| AI for Everyone: GitLab Chat   Issue                                                |
| AI for Everyone: Fill in merge request descriptions with AI   Issue                 |

## How to check if a customer has valid GitLab Duo Pro seats

Purchased duo pro seats are added as add-ons in a customer's main subscription that has either Premium or Ultimate seats.

For both Self-Managed and GitLab.com, impersonating the customer's account is the most straightforward method for checking if a subscription has Duo Pro seats:

1. Locate the customer's CustomersDot account by searching using the customer's email domain in <https://customers.gitlab.com/admin/customer>.

1. Impersonate the CustomersDot account that has a Subscription label and check the details for Duo Pro seats

- NOTE: Always check the start and end date of the Duo Pro add-on seats

Other optional methods are below:

- For Self-Managed, follow the below steps until Duo Pro seat count is displayed in Licenses page is implemented:

1. Locate the customer's CustomersDot account by searching using the customer's email domain in <https://customers.gitlab.com/admin/license>.

1. Click on the i icon to navigate to the license details page.

1. Scroll down and copy the License Key.

1. Navigate to the Validate License page.

1. Paste the license key in the License File box and click on Validate.

1. Find the codesuggestionsseatcount value that is under the restrictions key. A non-zero value means that the customer should have Duo Pro seats available.

1. Alternatively, you can request the customer to verify by checking GitLab Duo Pro page in their instance.

- For GitLab.com, follow the below steps until Duo Pro seat count is displayed in Orders page and Display if a user has Duo Pro seat assigned in Admin page are implemented:

- If you have GitLab.com Admin access, verify the GitLab group has Duo Pro by checking the Usage Quotas page

How to check if a customer has a valid GitLab Duo Pro trial

When a customer follows these steps to start a GitLab Duo Pro trial, they get a 60 day trial for a maximum of 50 seats by default.

Self-Managed Duo Pro trials

1. Navigate to the Self-Managed Duo Pro trials page in CustomersDot.

1. Search using the customer's email domain, company name or subscription.

1. Alternatively, you can request the customer to verify by checking GitLab Duo Pro page in their instance.

- NOTE: Always check the start and end date of the Duo Pro trial

GitLab.com Duo Pro trials

All GitLab.com Duo Pro trials can be located using this query:

<https://customers.gitlab.com/admin/order?query=saas-gitlab-duo-pro-trial-plan-id>

1. Navigate to the Orders page in CustomersDot.

1. Search using the customer's Namespace ID.

1. Locate an order that has plan saas-gitlab-duo-pro-trial-plan-id.

1. If you have GitLab.com Admin access, verify the GitLab group has Duo Pro by checking the Usage Quotas page.

- NOTE: Always check the start and end date of the Duo Pro.

Troubleshooting AI

While we have customer facing troubleshooting documentation, you can also look for more information in Kibana pubsub-mlops-inf-gprd- index. Use one of the following keywords to search:

- json.jsonPayload.gitlabhostname, the value for GitLab.com is gitlab.com.
- json.jsonPayload.url, <https://codesuggestions.gitlab.com/> for GitLab Code Suggestion and <https://cloud.gitlab.com/v1/chat/agent> for GitLab Duo chat.

When troubleshooting make sure to get debug logs for the relevant extension.

Feel free to open issues for how AI team can collaborate with support team in the editor extensions Team issue tracker <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-org/editor-extensions/meta/-/issues>.

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/browserstack.md

## BrowserStack

We have access to an application called BrowserStack which allows you to load different browser versions on Windows/Mac/Android/iOS to reproduce potential browser issues on these Operating Systems.

The credentials are in 1Password.

Once logged in, you should navigate to the browser dashboard and choose your desired Operating System / browser.

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/calendly.md

Note: Always use single-use Calendly links when offering a call with customers.

## Calendly setup

You will have set up Calendly as part of your GitLab onboarding, following the instructions in tools and tips.

Modify your setup as follows

- log in
- Set up Zoom integration on your Calendly account in integrations
- Ensure you have a one-hour event available.
- Edit your Calendly events:
  - Ensure the event names have 'Support' in their title.
  - Consider changing your availability increment (see below)
  - Location may show as 'Zoom conference call' but won't actually be using the integration. Edit the location, and select zoom (with the blue camcorder icon)

## Availability schedule setup

```
<figure class="videocontainer">  
  <iframe src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/QeqvcjZEVpM" frameborder="0"
```

```
allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
</figure>
```

Setting up your availability schedules is very important. This ensures you get scheduled calls during your intended hours as well as ensures you can be added to the various events we use.

The above video shows how to set this up, but the general gist is:

- Navigate to <https://calendly.com/app/availability/schedules>
- Set the timezone for your default schedule
- Rename the default schedule to "Working hours"
- Edit the hours you are available

### GitLab Support group account

You need to be added to the GitLab Support group account to enable the Calendly Pro account features, including the ability to add multiple "event types" for scheduling calls with customers and colleagues as recommended in the suggestions below.

To get added to the group account:

1. Open a Schedule update request issue
1. Assign to your manager, and they'll approve and assign it over to a team member who provisions Calendly.

This access is also included as part of support onboarding for GitLab Support Engineers that will be handling tickets for self-managed customers.

### Availability increment

Calendly 60 minute meetings default to an 'availability Increment' of 60 minutes.

Only slots starting at the top of the hour are offered. If you've got 90 minutes available, or a (say) a 14:30-15:30 window available, then reducing the increment to 30 minutes increases your availability.

- Log in and edit the event type
- Click on Scheduling settings
- Under Additional options, select a time interval under Start time increments

If you have any other meeting lengths available, consider whether it makes sense to offer different start times.

You can view your calendly availability using a private/incognito browser session.

### Temporarily changing your timezone

If you are temporarily working hours different to your usual schedule, you can update Calendly so that customer calls will be booked during your updated timezone.

1. Log in to Calendly. Click the Availability tab (or use this URL).
1. In the Schedule > Working hours area, use the Time zone dropdown to select your updated timezone. Changes are automatically saved.
1. Set a calendar reminder for yourself to reset your timezone when your working hours have reverted to usual.

Set the minimum amount of notice that is required for an event

You can specify scheduling conditions that disallow scheduling events within a configurable interval of an event start time.

1. Log in and edit the event type
1. Click Scheduling settings
1. Under Event limits, select a time interval under Minimum notice
1. Click Save and close

Support calls in the team calendar

We copy customer calls to the GitLab Support Google calendar using a Zapier zap. For this to work

- Your calendly account must be part of the group account.
- The word 'support' triggers the integration. Ensure 'support' is in the event name in Calendly.

If the Zap is working, you should see the calendar event copied within a minute or two. If the customer cancels, similarly, it'll be removed from the Support calendar.

Ticket ID in calendar events

Please add a required question to your personal Calendly customer events. This question should ask the customer to enter the GitLab Support ticket number when they schedule with you. This ensures the ticket number is shown on the calendar events, and provides context for others to join and help out on a call.

Generating a single-use Calendly link

using Chrome plug-in / Firefox extension

Calendly has a Chrome plug-in and a Firefox extension that makes it easy to generate a single-use link to send to the customer. After adding it to your browser, look for the Calendly icon at the top right in your browser. Sign in to Calendly, then you will see a list of events. Then simply click on the Copy link icon under the event of your choice to generate a link you can paste into your message to the customer.

If you do not want to use a supported browser, you can generate a link from your Calendly home page according to the Calendly documentation.

using curl

Set your Calendly API token:

```
plaintext
t=<your Calendly API token>
```

Get your personal URI:

```
plaintext
uri=$(curl -s -H "Authorization: Bearer $t" \
  https://api.calendly.com/users/me | jq -r '.resource.uri')
```

List your available events:

```
plaintext
curl -sG -H "Authorization: Bearer $t" \
  -d user=$uri \
  "https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes" \
  | jq -r '.collection[]|select(.active == true)|([.name,.uri] | join(","))' \
  | column -s',' -t -d
```

This will generate a table such as this:

```
plaintext
15 Minute Meeting      https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/DGFGYBLAHK4CNXJF
30 Minute Coffee Call  https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/DEBLAHWQSO3GGUES
GitLab Government Customer Call https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/DADPABBLAHWZY57A
GitLab Support Call     https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/CEGFRWO2BLAHSAQE
Upgrade Assistance      https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/AHBRCBLAH6ECV5E6
Pairing Session         https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/EBLAHIHDJDRSS42
Support call with me    https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/DBLAH4WXTM7ADUB2
US Government Upgrade Assistance https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/BLAHTQKLLSHV3GL3
```

To generate a single-use link for the "Support call with me" event:

```
plaintext
curl -s -H "Authorization: Bearer <your Calendly API token>" \
  -F maxeventcount=1 \
  -F ownertype=EventType \
  -F owner=https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/DBLAH4WXTM7ADUB2 \
```



```
https://api.calendly.com/schedulinglinks \
| jq -r '.resource.bookingurl'
```

This will output something like the following:

```
plaintext
https://calendly.com/d/m6we-x8r7/support-call-with-me
```

using httpie

The following uses the same setup, patterns, and output as above with httpie.

Get your personal URI:

```
plaintext
uri=$(https https://api.calendly.com/users/me \
  Authorization:"Bearer $t" \
  | jq -r '.resource.uri')
```

List your available events:

```
plaintext
https -b api.calendly.com/eventtypes \
  user==$uri \
  Authorization:"Bearer $t" \
  | jq -r '.collection[]|select(.active == true)|([.name,.uri] | join(","))' \
  | column -s',' -t -d
```

Generate a single-use link:

```
plaintext
https -b api.calendly.com/schedulinglinks \
  Authorization:"Bearer $t" \
  maxeventcount=1 \
  ownertype=EventType \
  owner=https://api.calendly.com/eventtypes/DBLAH4WXTM7ADUB2 \
  | jq -r '.resource.bookingurl'
```

Protecting Customer Call events by making them Secret in Calendly

Customer Calls should be invitation-only. To do this, ensure all your Customer Call events are a Secret event. By doing this, only those who have the Calendly link to the specific event can see the meeting with you.

NOTE: If you do not take this action, then anyone can see your Customer Call events on your

public Calendly page.

1. Edit any of your events (specifically, the ones that you use for Customer Calls).
1. Click the Settings ({{settings}}) icon in the sidebar on the left side of the page.
1. Click Make secret.
1. Leave the page. Check the Calendly documentation in case of any issues.

### Auto block PagerDuty shifts in Calendly

It is possible to automate the blocking of your PagerDuty shifts in Calendly, so you are not booked for a customer call while you are on duty. This works by subscribing to your PagerDuty on-call schedule in Google Calendar, and then having Calendly use this when checking for conflicts. To set this up:

1. In PagerDuty, navigate to Your profile > On-Call Shifts > Export > WebCal feed. Right-click and copy the URL.
1. Add the PagerDuty calendar to your Google Calendar Other calendars > + > From URL and paste the WebCal URL from step 1.
1. In Calendly, navigate to Account > Calendar Sync > Configuration > Check for conflicts and click the Edit button.
1. Ensure that the PagerDuty calendar added in step 2 is selected here (it will be listed as "On Call Schedule for Your Name", not the name you gave it in Google), and then click the Update button. If your calendar does not appear in the list, you can disconnect and reconnect your Google Calendar account from Calendly to refresh the calendar list.

### Send customers the combined availability suggestions of multiple colleagues

Using a similar principle as for blocking your PagerDuty shifts, it is also possible to make Calendly present only those time slots which are available for multiple GitLab colleagues. This is useful when other Support Engineers, developers or managers need to attend a customer call

1. In Google Calendar Other calendars > + > Subscribe to calendar, start typing the name of your colleague and click on their auto-completed name to subscribe.
1. In Calendly, navigate to Account > Calendar Sync > Configuration > Check for conflicts and click the Edit button.
1. Add your colleague's calendar to the availability check via their ·@gitlab.com entry.
1. After the call has been scheduled, remove that entry again.

### Suggestions

Ben Prescott

- I have a 25 minute and 50 minute meeting available for internal GitLab meetings, and separate 30 minute and 60 minute ones called 'GitLab Customer support'. These are the ones I send links to in Zendesk.

- I offer 60 minutes by default, and changed the description/instructions as follows. I include the last line as we had a customer book for 3am their time, and can only assume Calendly got

their time zone wrong.

> This will be a Zoom Meeting.

>

> Let me know via the ticket if you have any questions, will need to use a different conference platform, or if you want a link to schedule a 30 minute call instead (which may be available sooner.)

>

> Check that your time zone and current time are displayed correctly on this page (below the calendar.)

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/chatops.md

## Overview

ChatOps commands can be used to service support requests for GitLab.com, especially useful when one does not have admin access. In the interest of maintaining a single source of truth, it is recommended to use the built-in "help" command within ChatOps to see what commands are available or inspecting the code itself.

Note: Before you can use ChatOps, you will need to request access.

## Namespace

Uses the GitLab API for managing namespaces.

/chatops run namespace --help

> Note:

If you are attempting to search for a sub-group and not a top level group, you'll need to ensure the slash / is encoded to %2F. For example, the path of the sub-group gitlab-com/support should be entered as gitlab-com%2Fsupport.

## Setting minutes quota for a namespace

/chatops run namespace minutes cutecat 10000

The number you use should be the total that extrasharedrunnersminuteslimit should be when you are done. For example, if the value of extrasharedrunnersminuteslimit is 1,337 and you want to add 1,000 additional minutes for the namespace cutecat, you want the value of extrasharedrunnersminuteslimit to be 2,337 when you are done. The command would look like this:

/chatops run namespace minutes cutecat 2337

## User

Uses the GitLab API for managing users.

```
/chatops run user --help
```

## Feature Flags

- Used for checking whether a specific feature flag has been enabled on GitLab.com or not.
- Used for enabling a feature flag on a project or a group.

```
/chatops run feature --help
```

---

```
## SECTION: support/workflows/cmoc_practice_events.md
```

## CMOC Practice Events

Support Engineering aims to conduct practice CMOC incident events globally every quarter. The exact date & time of each event (1 per region) will not be known to the CMOC ahead of time. This is to simulate the nature of live events being unexpected.

### Purpose

The practice events provide an opportunity to practice the activities and processes related to the CMOC responsibility. They are not a test that can be passed or failed, but rather a team exercise to gain experience, and an opportunity to iterate on the process and documentation.

### Outcomes

- Familiarity with tools like Status.io so that in a real emergency they're not a blocker to communication
- Increased familiarity with the CMOC process and confidence in a live event
- Familiarity with the incident room, Slack incidents-dotcom channel and how communication is formalized between Incident Manager, EOC and CMOC during the course of an incident
- An opportunity to retrospect and get live feedback from a friendly audience

### Participants

- a manager or senior support engineer will fulfill the role of the Incident Manager (and EOC if appropriate) and facilitate the practice event and scenario
- a note taker (another manager or senior engineer) will take notes of any learnings, improvements or gaps in documentation or process identified during the event
- the rostered CMOC will participate as though it were a live incident (but without the pressure of an actual incident or busy incident room!)

### Practice event tools, artefacts, references

- Practice event Issue template
- Practice Environment for status.io - status.io test
- Event feedback template - coordinator of quarterly event creates a new version for the quarter
- Script library - confidential to Support Managers (and SEs who may carry out the Incident

Manager role for practice events)

- CMOC workflow handbook page
- Incident roles and responsibilities handbook page

How to: Create and coordinate a quarterly practice event

Assumption: a DRI has been assigned to act as the coordinator for the quarter. The following needs to be completed (or delegated for completion) by the coordinator:

- Start by creating a new practice event issue from the template

The template includes instructions of other artefacts to create and how to schedule the events.

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/cmoc\_workflows.md

## Introduction

As the GitLab SaaS Incident Communications Manager on Call (CMOC) you are the voice of GitLab to our users and stakeholders during an incident. To do this effectively, you'll work primarily with the Incident Manager (IM) and Engineer on Call (EOC) and use a combination of our status page (powered by Status.io), Slack, Zendesk, incident.io and GitLab itself. The CMOC rotation is one of the rotations that make up GitLab Support On-call.

To disambiguate this term on other pages, you may see the acronym ICMOC or see the role referred to as "Incident CMOC". As this page is scoped to only this role it uses CMOC, Incident CMOC, and ICMOC interchangeably.

Our Slack bot Woodhouse provides a command (/woodhouse incident post-statuspage) to quickly spin up an incident on Status.io. From there, the basics of how to update and close incidents in Status.io are covered by their Incident Overview documentation. This document covers how GitLab specifically uses Status.io to perform those tasks.

How to be added to the CMOC PagerDuty rotation

To be added to the CMOC Rotation:

1. First, complete the GitLab-com CMOC training module.
1. After discussion and agreement with your manager, create a new PagerDuty Issue requesting that you are added to the appropriate regional CMOC rotation.

## Things to Know

Before getting started, take note of the following sections or to get straight into the workflow start at Incident Management.

## About Incidents

This section contains information specific to how incidents are started, what various status

messages in PagerDuty mean, and the difference between the EOC and the IM during an incident.

## How Incidents Are Declared

Infrastructure uses incident.io to declare incidents through Slack. Doing so will:

1. Automatically page the EOC, IM, and CMOC.
1. Create an issue for the incident in the Production issue tracker.
1. Create a dedicated Slack channel for the incident. It also generates an incident zoom call and an incident.io homepage to keep track of private comments and timeline, [read more here](#)

This information will all be posted to Slack in the incidents channel by incident.io and it'll look similar to the following example.

GitLab team members are encouraged to use this method of reporting incidents if they suspect GitLab.com is about to face one.

## PagerDuty Status Definitions

- Triggered - "An incident exists that requires the attention of a CMOC."
- Acknowledged - "I have seen the page and am in the process of joining the incident Slack channel and Zoom call."
- Resolved - "I have joined the dedicated Slack channel for the incident along with the Zoom call, created the incident in Status.io, notified internal stakeholders, and labeled the incident issue and am actively working the incident."

NB: "Resolved" in PagerDuty does not mean the underlying issue has been resolved.

## Deciding Whether to Initiate Status Page Communications: EOC vs. IM

The IM is the DRI for the decision of whether to initiate public communications via the Status Page. When joining an incident as the CMOC you should inquire as to whether communications are currently required. On the rare occasion that an incident does not have an IM, the EOC assumes these responsibilities and you may ask them instead.

## Reviewing Past Incidents

You can always review past incidents if you need examples or inspiration for how to fill in the details for a current incident.

## About Status.io

## Updating Current Status & Current State

It is not possible to change the Current Status of the affected infrastructure of an incident or its Current State without making a formal update to the incident. It is acceptable to publish a new update to an incident in order to change either the Current Status of its affected infrastructure or its Current State regardless of how recently the last update on the

incident was published.

## Frequency of Updates

Status.io should be updated whenever we have new information about an active incident that our stakeholders should be aware of. Outside of that, it should be updated at a consistent rate depending on the severity of the incident as outlined in the table below.

Once you join the incident Zoom call, take note of any updates that have been made to Status.io and the time they were made at. Set a timer to remind yourself and stick to the time intervals below unless you make a note of how long it will be until the next status update. For example, if you're in "monitoring" it may be appropriate to specify an hour before the next update.

Provide a clear message and path forward

Use the following table as a guideline. If there aren't any material updates to post, but we are approaching the update frequency we can ask the incident manager about posting an update that explains that. For example, if we are in the process of resolving the issue, and we know the process is going to take some time (for example an hour or two), we can provide the update that explains that, and provide an explanation when the next update is going to be posted.

| Incident Status   Severity 1 Update Frequency   Severity 2 Update Frequency   Severity 3/4 Update Frequency |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Investigating   10m   15m   15m                                                                             |
| Identified   10m   30m   30m                                                                                |
| Monitoring   30m   60m   60m                                                                                |
| Resolved   No further updates required                                                                      |

What If I Don't Know What to Say?

- Provide a generic update based on the best information you have:

- We're seeing elevated error rates on GitLab.com, investigation is underway in: link  
- Some users are reporting connection issues to GitLab.com, we're working on it in: link  
- Craft a draft of what you think is correct. Whenever possible use "I intend to..." language when communicating with the IM and EOC:

- @incident-manager - I'm going to post: "We've isolated the network problem to the APAC region and are working with Cloudflare support to get it resolved.

- "In my next update I'm going to move the status to monitoring"

- Bias to action - you can post another update if there was an error in your last update.

- If there are no material updates to report, say something so that people know we care and are working on it. Below are a few example messages:

1. "No material updates to report. We're discussing if we should restore from backup or let the replica catch up first but we have not made a decision."

1. "No material updates to report. We tried starting the Gitaly servers but we're still missing connectivity."

1. "No material updates to report. We are doing a handover to a new CMOC since the current

CMOC has been at it for three hours straight."

1. "No material updates to report. We would like to thank Google for the hugops tweet we received. LINK"

- If you really don't know, it really is okay to ask!

#### Administrative Tasks on Status.io

Any updates outside documented incident updates that require administrator access to the GitLab System Status page should be initiated with this template.

The template will ping CMOC DRIs in scenarios where we need to update or add components. Before adding or changing components, please ensure to get a review from infrastructure counterparts from the appropriate Reliability Team.

#### About Contact Requests

Whether related to an ongoing incident or not, Infrastructure or Security may ask you to reach out to one or more users if they detect unusual usage. Please follow the Sending Notices workflow to action these requests. Additionally, refer to the End of Shift Handover Procedure for details on handing off contact requests.

#### How to Page the CMOC?

The CMOC can be paged during the incident declaration process. If the CMOC needs to be paged after an incident was created or for any other reason, see the How to engage the EOC, IM or CMOC? section of the main incident management handbook.

#### About Coordinating a Support Response

When there is an incident that results in unexpected customer impact, and requires a non-standard workflow or communication from Support, you should create a Support Response issue to help coordinate Support action and response.

Keep this issue updated as communication guidelines or workflows change so that it remains the single source of truth for Support-related information.

#### CMOC Performance Indicators

Success as a CMOC is determined by the following performance indicators:

- Time to Acknowledge PagerDuty Pages: Acknowledge all PagerDuty notifications within 15m and join the incident bridge. See Acknowledge the PagerDuty Page
- Frequency between status updates: Post status page updates according to severity at documented intervals or other cadence if so communicated. See Frequency of Updates.
- Stakeholder communication threads created per incident: Communicate incident existence to stakeholders according to the documented process. See: Notify Stakeholders.
- Handover issue created after a shift: At the end of every shift, create a handover issue to prepare the incoming CMOC. See: End of Shift Handover Procedure
- Contact requests opened during shift per completed contact request issue: Complete, handover



or otherwise communicate plan to complete all incoming contact requests. See: About Contact Requests

- Participation in one training event per quarter: Join at least one incident or participate in (or organize) a training activity. See: CMOC Training Activities

## Incident Management

As the CMOC you'll guide the incident through the following stages.

1. Stage 1: Engage - Creating the incident in Status.io, joining the incident Zoom call, notifying stakeholders, and labeling the incident issue.

1. Stage 2: Manage - Following along with the work being performed by the EOC and any assisting engineers to resolve the incident while making updates to Status.io along the way while adhering to the Frequency of Updates schedule in addition to creating a tag for the incident in Zendesk, and tagging and replying to tickets.

1. Stage 3: Monitor (Situational) - Setting the incident to Monitoring in Status.io for a period of time to ensure that the issue does not recur before we close it out. This stage may be skipped at the request of the IM.

1. Stage 4: Resolve - Setting the incident to Resolved, adding a post-mortem link in Status.io, and ensuring that there are no remaining Zendesk tickets that need tagging and a response.

The following sections outline how to perform each of the steps within these stages and should be performed in sequential order.

### Stage 1: Engage

Perform all of the following steps in order immediately after receiving a PagerDuty page.

#### Acknowledge the PagerDuty Page

Mark the page as acknowledged. This can be done through the mobile app, web interface or PagerDuty App in the supportgitlab-com Slack channel.

#### Join Incident Channel & Zoom

A link to the call is provided in the incident declaration post by incident.io in incidents.

Your role while on the call is to follow along while the incident is worked and make updates to Status.io either when asked to or when it's necessary. Oftentimes chatter in this room will be lively, especially in the early stages of an incident while the source of the issue is being discovered. Use your best judgment on when it's appropriate to speak up to avoid vocalizing at inopportune times. You can always ping anyone on the call through Slack if you need to ask a non-urgent question about the situation.

#### Upon First Joining

The first thing you should do is to verify that you can be heard by others in the room. To do this, say something like:

> "Hi, I'm the CMOC on duty. I intend to send an update, please review this in the Slack thread."

>

> "Hi, I'm the CMOC on duty, how can I help?"

Whatever you choose to say, make sure that you receive a verbal acknowledgement directed at you before you move on to focus on other aspects of the incident.

#### When CMOC Is Asked to Take Action

From time to time, you may be asked to perform some specific tasks in the room. Always verbally acknowledge any such asks by repeating your understanding of the ask back to the requestor. This helps everyone understand that the ask was heard, and also serves to verify that everyone has the same understanding of some action to be taken.

In some cases, the ask may be implicit, rather than explicit. If you're in doubt, always speak up and ask for confirmation. For example:

> IM: CMOC is here, we need to roll out a first update.

A good response would be to ask for confirmation that an action was requested:

> CMOC: IM, do you want me to send a first update on status.io?

A better response would be to assume that an action was requested, relay your intended course of action in response, and give the requestor the opportunity to provide input:

> CMOC: IM, acknowledged, I will draft an update for status.io and ping you in Slack for input.

#### Identify Related GitLab Issue

You may need to identify the related incident issue if it is to be shared with status.io.

To identify the issue:

- Click Overview found at the top of the Slack incident channel

- Open the related incident.io incident page

- The GitLab issue can be found on the right of the page

#### Create Incident

You can create an incident directly through the status.io website OR through Slack (provided by

Woodhouse). It is recommended to use the status.io website directly as it permits further customization of the incident beyond what the Slack form allows. It is also easier to confirm that the incident was created properly when using the status.io website.

If the incident is related to GitLab Duo features, please review GitLab Duo Special Handling

Create Through Status.io

To create an incident through Status.io click the New Incident button from the main dashboard:

Then, fill out all of the details of the incident. The following values should be changed:

Title - This should be brief and concise. The incident title should answer the question: In simple terms, what is the issue?

Current State - This should almost always be set to Investigating, as we normally don't know the cause of the incident at this early stage. If that is not the case and it has been communicated to you by the IM or EOC that we're aware of what the cause is, set this to Identified instead.

Details - In keeping with our value of transparency, we should go above and beyond for our audience and give them as much information as possible about the incident. This field should always include a link to the incident issue from the production issue tracker so that our audience can follow along.

Incident Status - This should be set to either Degraded Performance, Partial Service Disruption, or Service Disruption depending on the severity of the incident. If you're unsure of which to pick, ask the IM for guidance.

Broadcast - Make sure all boxes are checked.

Message Subject - Leave this at its default value.

Affected Infrastructure - Leave this unchecked and then check the box next to each specific component below it that is affected by the incident. If this box is checked then the value that you set for Incident Status above will be applied to all infrastructure components.

The following is an example of an incident ready to be created regarding a delay in job processing on GitLab.com, and is generally what this page should look like before being submitted based on the guidelines above.

Create Through Slack

You simply need to issue /woodhouse incident post-statuspage from anywhere on Slack. You will be presented with a pre-filled form that you can update to your liking. Once submitted, the incident will be broadcast to the following media:

- Email subscribers
- Webhook subscribers
- Slack subscribers
- IRC (gitlab on Libera Chat)
- MS Teams subscribers
- Twitter
- RSS feed
- iCalendar

## Notify Stakeholders

The CMOC now needs to notify internal stakeholders of the incident using the Incident Notifier Slack workflow. This should be done after the severity of the incident has been confirmed by the IM.

This workflow, once used, will ask you to fill out a form with details of the incident and will then post those details to developer-relations and customer-success. This serves to notify those teams of the incident. To engage the workflow:

1. Within the supportgitlab-com channel, type / in the message box to bring up the list of available workflows and select the Incident Notifier workflow.

1. Fill in the following details that are shared in the incidents-dotcom channel

- Summary: Brief summary, you can make it the same as the CMOC notice.
- Severity: Select the same severity as the Incident.
- Production issue: Link to the incident issue. eg: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gl-infra/production/-/issues/12345>

- Incident Slack Channel: Link to the incident slack channel. eg: incident-12345

- Status Page: Click on the incident to expand the full status page url. eg:

<https://status.gitlab.com/pages/incident/xxxxxxxx/xxxxxxxx>

1. Click Submit

This will submit to both developer-relations and customer-success channels.

## Resolve the PagerDuty Page

We mark the PagerDuty page as resolved once every other task in this stage has been completed. Resolve the page through the mobile app, web interface or PagerDuty App in the supportgitlab-com Slack channel.

## Stage 2: Manage

After all Stage 1 tasks have been complete we will manage the incident by making updates to it, creating a tag for it in Zendesk, and responding to any tickets in Zendesk that are related to it.

## Update Incident

To publicly communicate attention and progress incidents should be updated according to the frequency of incident updates table unless you communicate otherwise.

To update an active incident, click the incidents icon from the dashboard.

Then click on the edit button next to the incident.

Change the following values:

**Current State** - Change this to Identified if the IM or EOC has informed you that we have identified the cause of the incident. If we have not, leave it at Investigating. If we have rolled out a fix for the incident and will be entering a monitoring period, set this to Monitoring and then move on to Stage 3.

**Details** - Describe what has changed regarding the incident since your last update, being as concise and to the point as possible. If you can fit it into the character limit, consider including a link to the incident issue again as well.

**Broadcast** - Make sure all boxes are checked.

**Message Subject** - Leave this at its default value.

**Current Status** - Leave this to what you previously set it to when creating the incident, unless the scope of the incident has widened or narrowed. If you're unsure, consult with the IM.

**Set Status Level** - Keep this checked. If the incident has increased in scope and now affects additional components in addition to the ones originally selected, proceed to Update Affected Infrastructure after publishing your update.

A ready to be published update should look similar to the following.

Twitter has a 280 character limit, but we noticed that some tweets get truncated to 230 characters, such as this one. This can be due to twitter converting any URLs to a 23-character URL via their link shortener service.

Make sure to verify the update length before publishing it, and try to fit the main body of the message (before the final URL to the issue) in 220 characters. This leaves about 10 characters to display the final URL, if it gets truncated.

After the update has been published, visit the live status page to verify that it went through.

Update Affected Infrastructure or Title (Situational)

Proceed to either Title or Affected Infrastructure to learn how to change either.

Title

To update the title of an incident, click Incidents in the navigation bar and then the View Incident button next to the incident in question:

Click the pencil icon next to the current incident title, change it, then click Save.

### Affected Infrastructure

To update the affected infrastructure of an incident, click Incidents from the navigation bar and then the View Incident button next to the incident in question:

Click the pencil next to Affected Infrastructure, check the boxes next to the additional affected infrastructure, then click Save. Then, click Dashboard from the navigation menu, click the additional affected infrastructure from the Current Status menu, and change their status:

### Zendesk Tag

In order to track tickets submitted through Zendesk that relate to an incident, a zendesk tag is automatically added to all tickets that mention the incident issue.

The tag is available for use on other tickets. All tags that relate to incidents are in the format gitlab-comgl-infraproductiionissues with being the incident number, which can be found in the incident issue.

For all other internal or confidential incidents (such as security related incidents), a manual tag can be created since we would not be sharing a public link in the public ticket response. To create a manual tag:

1. Create or edit a ticket.
1. Start typing the name of the new tag in the Tags field with a format of comincident
1. Hit Enter.
1. Submit the ticket, either with a response included or not.

The tag will now be available to use on other tickets.

### Monitor Zendesk

While in the Manage Incident stage, routinely monitor Zendesk for new and existing tickets related to the incident and proceed to tag and respond to them. Use this Zendesk search to view all new tickets created in the last four hours. Alternatively, paste the following into the Zendesk search bar.

```
plain  
created>4hours orderby:createdat sort:desc group:none group:"support" -form:billing  
-form:security
```

Adjust the 4 if the incident began earlier than four hours ago.

### Stage 3: Monitor (Situational)

After the incident has been mitigated, we'll often begin a monitoring period to ensure that we do not see a recurrence of the issue. Monitoring typically lasts for 30 minutes, but it can vary and a specific amount of monitoring time may be requested by the IM. They may also request that the monitoring stage be skipped entirely. If this is the case, proceed directly to Stage 4.

To begin monitoring, edit the incident and change the following fields.

Current State - Change to Monitoring.

Details - Along with any information specific to the incident be sure to mention that all systems have returned to normal operation, that we're monitoring in order to ensure the issue doesn't recur, and provide an estimate for how long we'll be monitoring before we resolve the incident. For example:

> While all systems are online and fully operational, out of an abundance of caution we'll leave affected components marked as degraded as we monitor. If there are no recurrences in the next 30 minutes, we'll resolve this incident and mark all components as fully operational.

Broadcast - Make sure all boxes are checked.

Message Subject - Leave this at its default value.

Current Status - Leave this at its previously set value. At this point, affected infrastructure should be back to operating normally, but to avoid confusion we do not set this back to Operational until we are ready to close the incident.

A ready to be published update that switches the incident over to the monitoring period should look similar to the following.

If at any point during the monitoring period we see a recurrence of the issue, return to Stage 2. If the monitoring period completes with no recurrence of the issue, proceed to Stage 4.

### Stage 4: Resolve

After we have completed the monitoring period, or if the monitoring period was skipped, we will now close the incident, add a link to the post-mortem section of the incident, and check Zendesk for any remaining tickets that need tagging and a response.

### Resolve Incident

Once we've confirmed that the issue has been resolved and the IM has given the all-clear, we will close the Status.io incident. If these conditions are met, make an update to the incident

and change the following fields.

Current State - Change to Resolved.

Details - State that the issue has been resolved and that systems have returned to operating normally. Be sure to also include a link to the incident issue even if you've already done so in previous updates so that any users who missed them know where to go for more info.

Broadcast - Make sure all boxes are checked.

Message Subject - Leave this at its default value.

Current Status - Change to Operational.

Set Status Level - Check this box.

A ready to be published update that closes the incident should look similar to the following.

After the incident has been closed double check that the status page looks right.

#### Add Post-Mortem

A review will be conducted by production engineering for every incident that matches a certain criteria. Status.io allows us to add a link to a post-mortem after an incident has been resolved which will then be viewable on our status page for that specific incident.

Do the following to add a post-mortem to a resolved incident:

1. From the dashboard click the Incidents button.

1. Scroll down and click on the title of the incident.

1. Click Add Post-Mortem and supply the link to the issue being used for the incident review, this is usually the same issue that was opened for the incident.

#### Check Zendesk

As a final step, perform one more check of Zendesk and ensure that there are no remaining tickets that need to be tagged and responded to. Refer back to the Monitor Zendesk section for how to do this.

#### Maintenance Management



Infrastructure will at times plan scheduled maintenance events for GitLab.com, some of which will directly impact users. New maintenance events are announced as issues created in the gl-infra/production issue tracker using the externalcommunication.md issue template accompanied by the Scheduled Maintenance label.

In the event that a maintenance will affect users, infrastructure can request that the maintenance be visible on our status page. Maintenance events have automation enabled, to ensure each event is started at the scheduled time. The CMOC may be requested to actively provide status updates throughout the maintenance event. When this is required, automation is disabled on the task and all future updates must be conducted manually, including the final completion of the maintenance window. ~~In these cases infrastructure will apply the CMOC Required label to the issue, causing a notification to be sent to the supportgitlab-com channel that mentions the on-call CMOC. Once this notification is received the CMOC uses the details within the issue to create the maintenance in Status.io.~~ These notifications are currently inoperative. Instead, the maintenance creator will post in supportgitlab-com using the @cmoc mention to notify the CMOC that a new maintenance requires setting up.

To create a new maintenance event, click New Maintenance from the Status.io dashboard.

The contents of the maintenance should be filled out according to the details provided in the maintenance issue. Once complete, it might look something like the following.

#### Timezones and Dates for Maintenance

The timezone of Status.io is set to UTC.

The date format is DD-MM-YYYY, because the ISO format is not an option as of 2022-08-12.

#### Rescheduling a Maintenance Event

In case you are required to reschedule a maintenance window, Go to status.io > Maintenances tab

Select the maintenance you need to reschedule.

Update the new schedule time by hitting on the Reschedule Maintenance button Make sure you have the correct timezone details when updating Then hit save.

#### Sending Updates About Maintenance Events

> Note About Automated Maintenance Events: On the Maintenance Event page you may see Automation: Running with red text in parenthesis next to it reading (Disable).

Once (Disable) has been clicked and subsequently disabled it cannot be re-enabled.

In order to Post Update and Finish Maintenance the automated Maintenance Event must be (Disable).

After being disabled all future updates, including starting the Maintenance Event must be performed manually from that point forward.

To send an update about a maintenance event, such as a reminder, go to the Maintenances tab in Status.io and select the one that needs an update. On the maintenance's information page, make note of whether automatic email reminders are set to go out. If yes, make sure not to send email broadcasts for your update in order to avoid sending duplicate reminders to subscribers. Once ready to update, select the Post Update Without Starting button.

Enter the update details provided by the Infrastructure team and have them confirm the appropriate broadcast channels before proceeding to send the update. If "Send Reminders" was enabled in the maintenance information page, be sure not to check "Notify email subscribers" in the broadcast settings.

Once the GitLab Status Twitter account has posted about the maintenance schedule, send a link of the tweet to the socialmediaaction channel to let the social team know that you'd like amplification on our GitLab brand twitter account. This should only be used once during a selected scheduled maintenance timeline, preferably mid-week prior to the scheduled maintenance.

#### End of Shift Handover Procedure

The CMOC rotation has some specific procedures for handover that substantiate what's in the general On-call - Ending your on-call shift) section.

It's necessary to inform the ingress CMOC of any relevant activity that occurred during your shift or if there are incidents that are still ongoing. To perform a handover create an issue in the CMOC Handover issue tracker using the Handover template. Do this even if nothing happened during your shift, signaling that everything is fine is also useful information.

If handover occurs during an active incident where the quick summary you'd provide in the issue is insufficient to properly prepare the ingress CMOC of the situation, you are encouraged to start a Zoom call in supportgitlab-com and invite the ingress CMOC to it so that they can be caught up synchronously. You can use the following slash command to expedite setting the meeting up.

```
plain  
/zoom meeting CMOC Handover Briefing
```

While the CMOC Handover issue tracker is open to the public, the template defaults to confidential in an effort to prevent accidental leakage of confidential information.

If the CMOC is called to participate in a new or ongoing SIRT incident during the shift, at handover invite the ingress CMOC to any related confidential issues/slack channels.

Contact requests opened during a shift should by default be assigned to the Support Engineer that created the ticket. It can be useful to mention the request for awareness of the next shift. However, it's not necessary to re-assign the contact request or continue to include it in subsequent handoffs unless action needs to be taken. In many cases, users don't respond to the contact request. You may want to consider re-assigning contact requests and handing it off to another shift if you intend to be OOO, for example.

## CMOC Training Resources

### CMOC Shadow PagerDuty Schedule

NOTE: When adding yourself to this rotation, be aware that adjusting the Time Zone field at the top of the page will adjust it for all users, not just yourself. Before you navigate away, please reset the timezone to UTC.

The CMOC Shadow Schedule can be used by anyone who wishes to shadow the CMOC to learn before officially acting as CMOC. A soon-to-be-CMOC should speak to their manager to get added to the rotation. Or, to shadow for a short span of days, they can click Schedule an Override, then click Custom duration and then select the time zone and the start and end dates and times before clicking the Create Override button to save the changes. To remove overrides, click the x on the override to be removed in the list of Upcoming Overrides on the right side of the screen.

> Note About CMOC Shadowing: When the CMOC shadow PagerDuty schedule is active the engineer will receive notifications and get paged the same way as when on the CMOC schedule. Do not acknowledge or resolve any incidents when on the CMOC shadow schedule as this will stop any potential pages to the real CMOC!

## CMOC Training Activities

A "training activity" for CMOCs is an activity under which CMOCs are exposed to items in the workflow with the expressed purpose of maintaining or increasing performance against CMOC performance indicators.

Some example training activities are:

- Tabletop exercises
- A "CMOC Squawk" in which CMOCs in a region synchronously or asynchronously discuss process improvements, tips and tricks
- Being the CMOC or shadowing an actual incident: real life training is training too!
- Practice Events

### CMOC Practice events

Practice events are meant to provide more experience for the person wanting to CMOC a real incident. They include a practice scenario that requires them to update the status page, communicate with the incident manager as well as provide more confidence.

To start a CMOC Practice event ask your trainer or any support engineer to go to the Support Team Meta issue tracker and to create an issue with the CMOC Practice Event issue template.

## GitLab Duo Special Handling

As GitLab Duo features are under active development we have a special issue dedicated to tracking individual feature availability at <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gl-infra/production/-/issues/18352>.

In the event of an incident being declared for a GitLab Duo feature, verify that the incident issue is crosslinked with <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/gl-infra/production/-/issues/18352>.

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## SECTION: support/workflows/communication-tips.md

This page is intended to provide general communication tips for the GitLab Support Department. Anything related to communication useful for this department is welcome here. It is meant to be an extension of the GitLab Communication handbook page.

Examples:

1. How can a Support Engineer efficiently talk to other Support Engineers via Slack, Zoom or e-mail?
1. How can a Support Engineer get the most out of their interaction with a team members posting in support Slack channels?

## Tickets

Whenever there is a discussion in Slack regarding a ticket, please remember to add a link to the discussion as an internal note on the ticket. Because all Slack posts are removed after 90 days, please either summarize the Slack discussion in that internal note or, if it's not too long, simply paste it in. These actions make it possible for others to use the information from the discussion to help themselves to contribute to the ticket, or simply to learn from it.

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/community-support.md

## Technical Support in the Community Forum

The Community Forum is the official place for our wider community to seek technical support assistance with GitLab.

Technical support solutions shared in the forum reach a wide audience as they are indexed by search engines, making them easily discoverable to GitLab users looking for solutions.

Oftentimes, technical problems encountered and questions asked by our wider community have

known solutions and answers that were provided to customers by GitLab Support team members in Support tickets. In this situation, having Support Engineers sharing these known tech support solutions in the community forum can be a highly effective form of ticket deflection.

### Docs-first Community Assistance

Similar to GitLab Support ZenDesk tickets, unsolved GitLab technical support threads in the forum are often an opportunity to:

- link to the relevant documentation
- improve docs based on user interaction/feedback

As such, GitLab Support Engineers should default to using a Docs-first approach to Community Assistance.

The critical points of the Docs-first approach for Community Assistance are:

- Always (try to) respond with a link to the docs.
- If you find helpful content missing from our documentation, create a merge request or issue to add it. Then link the MR or issue in your reply.
- If a Community member says the documentation is incorrect, confusing, or deficient - encourage them to create an issue explaining the problem or contribute an MR to fix it.

### Special types

There are several "special types" of content that are not well-suited for our documentation, such as Tutorials, "How-to" guides, and context-specific explanations.

A docs-first approach to Community Assistance in the Forum can help fill these "special type" gaps by making relevant answers/solutions easily discoverable and readily available.

For example, these Community forum threads where answers and solutions are "special types" that don't "fit" into the docs:

- Situation-specific Tutorials/How-tos - (eg. "I'm running GitLab CE 11.0 as a Docker container, and I want to upgrade to GitLab 13.2 EE Omnibus with minimal downtime, how can I do this safely?")
- Context-based Explanation - (eg. "I read the docs, but I don't understand how to do X.")
- Problem-specific Troubleshooting steps (eg. "I upgraded GitLab from 12.9 to 13.1 and now it's not working, I get 404 error on every page - please help!")

### Community Assistance Workflows

- First Responder - early detection of customer-facing problems, bugs, and regressions
- Silo-breaker - publicly share solutions/answers relevant to free users
- Fruit picker - pick low-hanging fruit for quick, easy wins
- Fishing Instructor - teaching Self-service and Community-first GitLab Support

### First Responder

For detecting bugs, improving documentation, and identifying problems in our product that will affect paying customers, the GitLab community is an excellent resource.

The Community Forum is an early detection and early alert system for customer-facing problems.

GitLab FOSS makes up over 80% of the GitLab codebase. Any technical problems with this 80% of the codebase impact all GitLab users, including customers.

Free users often surface up bugs, regressions, and problems with our product or docs in the Community forum before we start getting support tickets from customers about them.

#### Silo breaker

Silo-breakers take common answers/solutions in Support ZenDesk and ensure they're available and discoverable to all GitLab users.

Support team members may notice patterns or trends in incoming Support tickets - new FAQs, increasingly common problems, confusion regarding a new feature, unclear documentation, or bugs affecting customers.

We communicate internally, usually via Slack and Support Week in Review, to raise awareness in Support and help anyone who encounters tickets on the subject.

If these same patterns or trends are present in the Community forum, providing answers and solutions in forum threads helps ensure answers/solutions are discoverable via a search engine.

#### Fruit-picker

Specializes in picking "low-hanging fruit" by publicly sharing known answers and solutions.

- Quick, easy wins. ("I know the problem/question and can easily explain the solution/answer")
- The answer is in our documentation. (polite link to docs is sufficient)
- Single-touch Solutions. (no follow-up required)

#### Fishing Instructor

It is more worthwhile to teach someone to do something (for themselves) than to do it for them (on an ongoing basis).

The forum is like fishing, "Toss in a question or problem, get an answer or solution".

"Fishing instruction" in this context is an opportunity to showcase the resources available and how to find them. (docs, issues, MRs, codebase, forum threads).

Currently, we have a lot of folks reach out to Support without first looking for easy answers/solutions.

mermaid

graph TD

A[GitLab technical problem question]

A --> C(Ask for help)  
A --> D(Search for answer/solution)  
C --> 1a(Support) --> E  
C --> 1b(Forum) --> E  
D --> E(Find answer/solution)  
D --> F(Don't find answer/solution) --> C(Ask for help)

The most efficient and effective way to connect users with appropriate support option is to act in a way that encourages and increases the following support-seeking user flow.

```
mermaid
graph LR
  A(Question/Problem) --> B(Am I a Customer?)
  B --> C(Y)
  B --> D(N)
  C --> E(Support)
  D --> F(Forum)
  E --> G(Success)
  F --> G
```

"Fishing instructors" enable and empower GitLab users and customers to catch their own fish - find solutions and answer questions without Support intervention.

By directing incoming Free user tickets to the Community forum, free users get in the habit of finding answers/solutions without relying on GitLab Support.

### Optimal Free User Support Experience

Win-win-win - benefits GitLab community, customers, and team members.

- [x] self-serve support
- [x] docs-first
- [x] ticket deflection

```
mermaid
graph LR
  A1(Question about GitLab) & B1(Problem using GitLab) --> D(Search for answer/solution)
  D --> E(Find answer/solution)
```

### Additional Resources

For additional tips and best practices when working in the Community forum, refer to the

Developer Relations Handbook entry for the Community forum.

---

## SECTION: support/workflows/confirmation\_emails.md

## Overview

This workflow covers cases when a user says they are not receiving their confirmation email. The activation token in a confirmation email will only be valid for 24 hours. Thereafter, the user will need a new confirmation email.

### Stage 0: Ticket Triage

Before working the ticket ensure that it's correctly triaged with the SaaS Account form and Did not receive confirmation email problem type so that the SaaS Account Ticket Helper application can activate.

If the user has already correctly chosen the problem type, the automation will activate when an agent opens the ticket for the first time. If the SaaS Account Ticket Helper application fails to solve the issue for any reason, proceed to manually resolve it by going through the steps in the following sections.

### Stage 1: Locate Account

Before the issue can be resolved we first need to locate the account in question. This can be done by either checking the GitLab User Lookup App or by checking GitLab Admin.

#### Method 1: Check GitLab User Lookup App

1. Click the Apps button located in the top right of the Zendesk interface, while viewing the ticket.
1. Scroll down to t